

Under-\$5K Execution Kit — GamerGain / PlayEarning Nexus

Purpose: get a developer from "code on GitHub" to "live on web + Android + iOS" for **≤ \$5,000** at **\$75/hr (≤ ~66 billable hours)**. It works by removing the guesswork — every phase below ships with the exact config, copy, and steps, so the developer runs near the *low* end of the estimate instead of the high end.

Stack chosen: Railway (all-in-one) · iOS built in the cloud (no Mac).

The number

Phase	Before (h)	With this kit (h)	The file that cuts it
Accounts & API keys	8–12	6–8	API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md
Deploy backend + Postgres + scheduler	10–14	6–8	railway/RAILWAY-DEPLOY.md + railway/backend.railway.json
Pre-deploy validation	3–6	1–2	validate.sh
Deploy frontend	4–8	2–3	railway/frontend.Dockerfile
Payments sandbox→live	10–15	8–10	PAYMENTS-TEST-CHECKLIST.md
Survey loop test	6–10	4–6	SURVEY-LOOP-TEST.md
Android submission	15–22	10–13	ANDROID-SUBMISSION-KIT.md
QA pass	10–15	7–9	QA-CHECKLIST.md
Subtotal — PWA + Android	66–102	~44–59	≈ \$3,300–\$4,425
iOS submission (cloud CI, no Mac)	+6–12	+5–9	IOS-NO-MAC-KIT.md + ci/
Total — PWA + Android + iOS		~49–68	≈ \$3,675–\$5,100

Bottom line: PWA + Android lands **comfortably under \$5k** (~\$3.3–4.4k). Adding iOS via cloud CI keeps you **right around \$5k** — the only thing that can push it over is an Apple review rejection round (common for earn-money apps), so treat that as the single budget risk. There's no Mac purchase.

These are targets, not guarantees. The kit removes *discovery and rework* — the biggest causes of the high-end blowout. A clean run lands near the low column; a messy provider approval or an App Store rejection adds hours. Keep iOS review clean (demo login, "not gambling" framing) to protect the number.

Order of operations (hand this whole folder to the developer)

- Owner first:** fill in [API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md](#) (account signups are not billable dev work).
- `bash deploy-kit/validate.sh` — prove the build is green before touching the cloud.
- Railway:** follow [railway/RAILWAY-DEPLOY.md](#) → Postgres, backend, scheduler, frontend live.
- Money & loop:** run [PAYMENTS-TEST-CHECKLIST.md](#) then [SURVEY-LOOP-TEST.md](#) (sandbox → live).

5. **QA:** run `QA-CHECKLIST.md` on the live app.
6. **Android:** `ANDROID-SUBMISSION-KIT.md` → signed `.aab` → Play Console.
7. **iOS (no Mac):** `IOS-NO-MAC-KIT.md` → Codemagic (`ci/codemagic.yaml`) or GitHub Actions (`ci/ios-build.yml`) → TestFlight → App Store.

What is NOT in the \$5k (unavoidable, not "development")

- Apple Developer **\$99/yr** · Google Play **\$25** one-time · domain **~\$12-15/yr**.
- Monthly hosting: Railway at launch traffic **~\$10-30/mo**; provider/LLM usage on top (usage-based).
- Optional lawyer review of Privacy/Terms (templates provided; sign-off is the cost).

How to protect the budget (owner playbook)

- Do the **account signups yourself** — never pay dev hours for forms.
- Insist on **Phase 2 validate.sh** before any cloud work — it kills the #1 surprise.
- Ship **Android + iOS via CI** — no Mac purchase, no per-platform rewrite.
- Keep the **iOS review clean** (demo login, merit-not-gambling framing) to avoid rejection-round hours.
- Defer the **full AWS load test** until real traffic justifies it (the plan is ready when you need it).